



Google Wave on Thunderbird? That's a surprise

a new tab with the service open in it.

Knowing the robust Mozilla community, it won't be long before someone comes up with a great add-on or extension that lets you browse sites and web apps easily. But even as it stands right now, for a techie, Thunderbird 3 is an amazing communication management tool.

Another way to browse the internet or open web apps in TB3 is by using ThunderBrowse. Just create and save a draft email with all your favourite links in it. Open the draft and click on the links to start a tabbed session of ThunderBrowse within your client.

Autohide Tabs bar

If you aren't using any of the tabs and just have your inbox open, it does not make sense to waste any of that vertical screen realty. So let's go about auto-hiding the tabs bar, shall we? First, go to **Tools > Options > General Tab > Config Editor**. A warning will prompt you that this shall void your warranty (Thunderbird has a warranty?), so just accept that and click through it. In the filter box, type `mail.tabs.auto-hide` and hit [Enter]. If the value of the entry is set to false, double-click on it to change it to true.

Download images automatically

Thunderbird 3, for some reason, does not download

images sent with emails automatically. There are quite a few newsletters and other important mails we receive, as well as fun forwards, which depend heavily on these images. So how do you bypass this annoying feature?

First, go to **Tools > Options > General Tab > Config Editor**. The program will warn you that you are about to void your warranty; accept that. In the filter box, type `mailnews.message_display.disable_remote_`

your Thunderbird, there is a handy extension that can help you out. Called gContactSync, the experimental add-on is available on the official Thunderbirds add-on page at <https://addons.mozilla.org/en-US/thunderbird/addon/8451>.

Once installed, click on the extension in the add-ons pane and enter its Options mode. In the Accounts tab, click on the **Add Login** button and provide your user details, and hit OK. From here, gContactSync will take over, and within ten min-

in the various options available on the page. For example, with Windows Live Mail, the option is situated in the drop-down list when you click **Manage**.

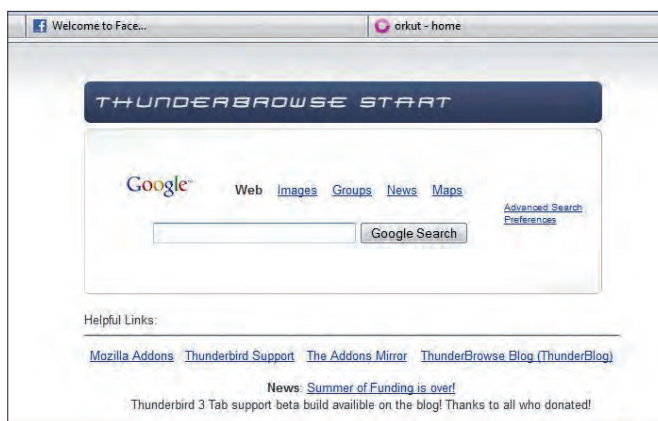
By default, most email services export your contact list in the CSV format, which both Outlook Express and Thunderbird can read. Some email providers give multiple format options; in that case, choose CSV or anything that is Outlook compliant.

Once you download and save the file to your hard drive, go to your Mozilla Thunderbird and select **Tools > Import**. In the first pane, choose **Address Book**. Next, choose text file (LDIF, TAB, CSV, TXT). Browse to the file on your hard drive when prompted. Put a check mark against the fields that you want imported and click OK. You're done!

This same method can also be applied to Gmail, of course, but with an extensions as awesome as gContactSync, the need would never come up.

Enable spell check

To avoid making spelling mistakes, Thunderbird 3 comes with a built-in spell check. However, you will first have to enable this. Go to **Tools > Options > Composition > Spelling**. Here, check **Check spelling before sending**. Currently, Thunderbird 3 supports only the American-spelling dictionary for English words, but this should soon be rectified, in all likelihood.



ThunderBrowse at work

image and hit [Enter]. If the value is set to false, double-click on it to change it to true.

Sync contacts

Thankfully, Mozilla has configured TB3 such that all your messages are synced brilliantly with Google's email service. However, a lot is left to be desired when it comes to the Contacts list.

To sync Google contacts with the address book for

utes, you should have your TB address book synced up with your Gmail contacts.

Import address book

If you use Yahoo! Mail, Hotmail or some other email service, then grabbing your contact list isn't as easy a procedure as installing an extension. In this case, first go to your email account's contact list through your browser. Select all your contacts and look for **Export**